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Circuit board module

Abstract

A circuit board module, including a circuit board body, two camera elements, two board-to-board connectors, and an external circuit board, is provided. The circuit board body includes a surface and at least one groove recessed in the surface. The two camera elements are disposed in the at least one groove and electrically connected to the circuit board body. The two board-to-board connectors are disposed on the circuit board body. The external circuit board includes two connection ports pluggably connected to the two board-to-board connectors, so that the external circuit board is electrically connected to the circuit board body.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION

(1) This application claims the priority benefit of Taiwan application serial no. 111126510, filed on Jul. 14, 2022. The entirety of the above-mentioned patent application is hereby incorporated by reference herein and made a part of this specification.

BACKGROUND

Technical Field

(2) The disclosure relates to a circuit board module, and in particular, to a circuit board module applicable to a thin device.

Description of Related Art

(3) In order to meet the application demand trend of today's users, electronic devices are becoming thinner and thinner. The goal of research in this field is, for example, how the circuit board module disposed by electronic elements, such as camera elements, should respond to this trend.

SUMMARY

(4) The disclosure provides a circuit board module which can be applied to thin devices.

(5) The circuit board module of the disclosure includes a circuit board body, two camera elements, two board-to-board connectors, and an external circuit board. The circuit board body includes a surface and at least one groove recessed in the surface. The two camera elements are disposed in the at least one groove and electrically connected to the circuit board body. The two board-to-board

connectors are disposed on the circuit board body. The external circuit board includes two connection ports pluggably connected to the two board-to-board connectors, so that the external circuit board is electrically connected to the circuit board body.

(6) In an embodiment of the disclosure, the at least one groove includes two grooves, and two camera elements are respectively disposed in the two grooves.

(7) In an embodiment of the disclosure, the circuit board body includes a wiring section between the two grooves. The two camera elements are electrically connected to each other through the external circuit board, but not electrically connected to each other through the wiring section.

(8) In an embodiment of the disclosure, the external circuit board includes a main section and two branches extending from the main section. The two connection ports are respectively disposed on the two branches and pluggably connected to the two board-to-board connectors.

(9) In an embodiment of the disclosure, the circuit board module further includes at least one first electronic element disposed on the surface and electrically connected to the circuit board body. Each board-to-board connector is disposed on the surface, and the height of each board-to-board connector and the first electronic element is less than the height of each camera element.

(10) In an embodiment of the disclosure, the circuit board module further includes at least one second electronic element disposed on the surface and electrically connected to the circuit board body. The height of each second electronic element is less than the height of each camera element.

(11) In an embodiment of the disclosure, each of the first electronic elements includes a microphone, and each of the second electronic elements includes a light source.

(12) In an embodiment of the disclosure, the at least one first electronic element includes two first electronic elements, and at least one second electronic element includes two second electronic elements. The two camera elements are adjacent to each other. The two first electronic elements are located on two sides of the two camera elements. The two second electronic elements are located on two sides of the two camera elements. The two board-to-board connectors are located on two sides of the two camera elements.

(13) In an embodiment of the disclosure, the at least one groove is one groove, and the two camera elements are disposed in the groove.

(14) In an embodiment of the disclosure, the external circuit board is provided with wiring and no electronic part is disposed on the external circuit board.

(15) In an embodiment of the disclosure, the thickness of the circuit board body at each groove is less than half of the thickness of the circuit board body at positions other than the at least one groove.

(16) In an embodiment of the disclosure, the thickness of the circuit board body at each groove is less than 0.2 mm, and the thickness of the circuit board body at positions other than the at least one groove is less than 0.5 mm.

(17) In an embodiment of the disclosure, the width of the circuit board body is less than 3 mm.

(18) In an embodiment of the disclosure, the width of the circuit board body is the same as the width of each camera element.

(19) Based on the above, the circuit board body of the circuit board module of the disclosure includes a groove recessed in the surface. The electronic element is, for example, a camera element, disposed in the groove and electrically connected to the circuit board body to reduce the overall height. In addition, because the circuit board body is provided with grooves, the space for disposing wiring on the circuit board body is relatively reduced. In order to obtain more wiring space, the connection port of the external circuit board is pluggably connected to the board-to-board connector of the circuit board body, so that the external circuit board is electrically connected to the circuit board body. Therefore, the wiring originally to be disposed on the circuit board body is changed to the external circuit board. The external circuit board is used to make up for the space for disposing wiring on the circuit board body, thereby optimizing the wiring disposition.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) FIG. 1 is a schematic perspective view of a circuit board module according to an embodiment of the disclosure.
- (2) FIG. 2 is a schematic exploded view of the circuit board module in FIG. 1.
- (3) FIG. 3 is a schematic side view of the circuit board module in FIG. 1.
- (4) FIG. 4 is a schematic partial enlarged view of the circuit board body of FIG. 3.
- (5) FIG. 5 is a schematic partial enlarged side view of a circuit board body of a circuit board module of an embodiment according to the disclosure.
- (6) FIG. 6 is a schematic partial enlarged view of a circuit board module according to an embodiment of the disclosure.
- (7) FIG. 7 is a schematic exploded view of FIG. 6.

DESCRIPTION OF THE EMBODIMENTS

(8) Embodiments are provided below for detailed description. However, the embodiments are used as examples for illustration, but not to limit the scope of the disclosure. In addition, the drawings in the embodiment omit some elements to clearly show the technical features of the disclosure.

Wherever possible, the same reference numbers are used in the drawings and the description to refer to the same or like parts.

(9) FIG. 1 is a schematic perspective view of a circuit board module according to an embodiment of the disclosure. FIG. 2 is a schematic exploded view of the circuit board module in FIG. 1.

Referring to FIG. 1 and FIG. 2, the circuit board module **100** of the embodiment is adapted to be disposed in the frame area of a thin electronic device (not shown), especially a thin electronic device with a narrow frame. The type of the electronic device is, for example, a notebook computer, a tablet computer, or a mobile phone, but not limited thereto. For example, the circuit board module **100** may be adapted to be disposed on the upper body of the notebook computer. Certainly, the circuit board module **100** of this embodiment may also be disposed in general electronic devices. The detailed structure of the circuit board module **100** is described below.

(10) As shown in FIG. 2, the circuit board module **100** of this embodiment includes a circuit board body **110**, at least one electronic element (for example, two camera elements **120**, but the type and number of electronic elements are not limited), at least one board-to-board connector **122** (for example, two board-to-board connectors), and an external circuit board **130**. In some embodiments, the camera element **120** may be a complementary metal oxide semiconductor (CMOS) sensor, a charge-coupled device (CCD) sensor, a thin-film transistor (TFT) sensor, an infrared lens, or other sensor that can obtain images, or a combination of these sensors.

(11) Since the circuit board module **100** is adapted to be located in the frame area of thin electronic devices, the width of the circuit board body **110** is narrow. In this embodiment, the width *W* of the circuit board body **110** is less than 3 millimeters (mm), thereby reducing the width occupied by the circuit board body **110** in the frame area. For example, the width *W* of the circuit board body **110** is 1.9 mm. The circuit board body **110** includes a surface **112** (for example, the upper surface **112**) and at least one groove **114** recessed in the surface **112**. The two camera elements **120** are disposed in the at least one groove **114** and electrically connected to the circuit board body **110**.

(12) In this embodiment, the at least one groove **114** includes multiple grooves **114** (for example, two grooves), and two camera elements **120** are respectively disposed in the two grooves **114**. That is, each camera element **120** is disposed in the corresponding groove **114**. In this embodiment, the number of grooves **114** corresponds to the number of camera elements **120**, and the size of grooves **114** roughly corresponds to the size of camera elements **120**. Such a design facilitates positioning. Certainly, the relationship between the number of grooves **114** and the number of camera elements **120** is not limited thereto.

(13) Compared with directly disposing the camera element **120** on the surface **112**, the design of disposing the camera element **120** on the groove **114** reduces the overall height of the circuit board module **100**, and is suitable for thin electronic devices.

(14) In addition, at least one (for example, two) board-to-board connectors **122** are disposed on the circuit board body **110**, particularly disposed on the surface **112** of the circuit board body **110**. The external circuit board **130** includes at least one (for example, two) connection ports **136** (FIG. 2) pluggably connected to the two board-to-board connectors **122**, so that the external circuit board **130** is electrically connected to the circuit board body **110**.

(15) It should be noted that because the circuit board body **110** of this embodiment is provided with the grooves **114**, the space for disposing wiring on the circuit board body **110** is relatively reduced. In this embodiment, the wiring originally to be disposed on the circuit board body **110** (such as power wiring, control signal wiring, high-speed differential signal wiring, etc.) is changed to be disposed on the external circuit board **130**. The external circuit board **130** is used to make up for the lost wiring space due to the groove **114** on the circuit board body **110**. Even other wiring that were originally to be disposed on the circuit board body **110** may also be disposed on the external circuit board **130**, thereby reducing the volume of the circuit board body **110**. Therefore, the circuit board module **100** optimizes the wiring disposition through the external circuit board **130**.

(16) In this embodiment, the external circuit board **130** includes a flexible circuit board which can be bent and has flexibility to adapt to the internal space of electronic devices. In other embodiments, the external circuit board **130** may also include a flex-rigid board, a rigid circuit board, or a cable. The designer may decide the material of the external circuit board **130** according to their needs.

(17) In this embodiment, the external circuit board **130** is provided with wiring and no electronic part is disposed on the external circuit board **130**. Since the external circuit board **130** only has wiring and no electronic part is disposed, the external circuit board **130** has lower requirements and is less limited by materials or styles. In addition, because no electronic part is disposed on the external circuit board **130**, the external circuit board **130** is thin and there is no problem of height limitation. Also, there is no problem of damage to the electronic part due to bending.

(18) In addition, the circuit board module **100** further includes at least one first electronic element **124** and at least one second electronic element **126**. The at least one first electronic element **124** and the at least one second electronic element **126** are disposed on the surface **112** and electrically connected to the circuit board body **110**. Specifically, in this embodiment, two camera elements **120** include two camera elements **120**, at least one first electronic element **124** includes two first electronic elements **124**, and at least one second electronic element **126** includes two second electronic elements **126**. Certainly, the number of the first electronic element **124** and the second electronic element **126** is not limited thereto.

(19) In this embodiment, each of the first electronic elements **124** includes a microphone, and each of the second electronic elements **126** includes a light source. Therefore, the circuit board module **100** provides the user with the effects of capturing images, receiving audio, and making fill light. Certainly, the type of the camera element **120**, the first electronic element **124**, and the second electronic element **126** is not limited thereto.

(20) In this embodiment, the first electronic element **124**, the second electronic element **126**, and the board-to-board connector **122** are all disposed on the same surface (surface **112**) of the circuit board body **110**, and the camera element **120** protrudes from the surface **112**.

(21) In addition, the two camera elements **120** are adjacent to each other and are located near the center of the circuit board body **110**. The two first electronic elements **124**, the two board-to-board connectors **122**, and the two second electronic elements **126** are located on two sides (outside) of the two camera elements **120**. Specifically, the two board-to-board connectors **122** are symmetrically located on two sides (outside) of the two camera elements **120**, while the two first electronic elements **124** are symmetrically located on two sides (outside) of the two board-to-board

connectors **122**, and the two second electronic elements **126** are symmetrically located on two sides (outside) of the two first electronic elements **124**. Certainly, the disposition relationship is not limited thereto.

(22) Certainly, in an embodiment, the two first electronic elements **124**, the two board-to-board connectors **122**, and the two second electronic elements **126** may also be located asymmetrically on two sides (outside) of the two camera elements **120**, respectively, which is not limited by the drawings. The designer may adjust the disposition position according to their needs.

(23) In this embodiment, the external circuit board **130** includes a main section **132** and multiple branches **134** (for example, two branches **134**) extending from the main section **132**.

(24) The two connection ports **136** (FIG. 2) are respectively disposed on the branches **134** and pluggably connected to the board-to-board connectors **122**.

(25) It should be noted that, in this embodiment, since the circuit board body **110** is provided with a groove **114**, the circuit board body **110** may have only one layer (but not limited to one layer) of wiring at the groove **114** for electrically connecting to the camera element **120**. In this case, the space between the two grooves **114** of the circuit board body **110** is insufficient to dispose other additional wiring. Therefore, in this embodiment, the circuit board body **110** includes a wiring section **116** between the two grooves **114**. In the wiring section **116**, ground shielding layers may be disposed, but the wiring for conducting the two camera elements is not disposed. In other words, in this embodiment, the wiring of the circuit board body **110** extends from the two grooves **114** to the left and right sides of the circuit board body **110**. That is to say, the camera element **120** of the groove **114** on the left side of the wiring section **116** is electrically connected to the board-to-board connector **122** on the left side of the wiring section **116** through the wiring, while the camera element **120** of the groove **114** on the right side of the wiring section **116** is electrically connected to the board-to-board connector **122** on the right side of the wiring section **116** through the wiring. Furthermore, the two camera elements **120** on two sides of the wiring section **116** are electrically connected to each other through the external circuit board **130**, but are not electrically connected to each other through the wiring section **116**.

(26) In addition, in this embodiment, the two first electronic elements **124**, the two board-to-board connectors **122**, and the two second electronic elements **126** are located on two sides (outside) of the two camera elements **120**, respectively, so that the camera element **120**, the first electronic element **124**, and the second electronic element **126** on the left half transmit signals through the circuit board body **110** on the left half. Furthermore, the camera element **120**, the first electronic element **124**, and the second electronic element **126** on the left half transmit signals to the branch **134** on the left side of the external circuit board **130** through the board-to-board connector **122** on the left half.

(27) Similarly, the camera element **120**, the first electronic element **124**, and the second electronic element **126** on the right half transmit signals through the circuit board body **110** on the right half. Furthermore, the camera element **120**, the first electronic element **124**, and the second electronic element **126** on the right half electrically connect the branch **134** on the right side of the external circuit board **130** through the board-to-board connector **122** on the right half.

(28) The main section **132** of the external circuit board **130** may be plugged into the main board (not shown), and the signals of the left and right halves of the circuit board body **110** are integrated from the two branches **134** to the main section **132** and then transmitted to the main board.

(29) In addition, the signal from the main board may also be transmitted to the left and right halves of the circuit board body **110** through the main section **132** and the two branches **134** of the external circuit board **130**. Besides, the wiring of the two branches **134** of the external circuit board **130** is conductive, so that the signals of the left and right halves of the circuit board body **110** may also be transmitted to each other through the external circuit board **130**. Certainly, in an embodiment, the wiring of the two branches **134** of the external circuit board **130** may also be independent of each other without being conducted to each other.

(30) FIG. 3 is a schematic side view of the circuit board module in FIG. 1. Referring to FIG. 3, in this embodiment, the height H2 of the first electronic element **124**, the height H3 of the second electronic element **126**, and the height H4 of the board-to-board connector **122** are all less than the height H1 of the camera element **120**. That is to say, in this embodiment, the camera element **120** with the largest height in the circuit board module **100** is disposed in the groove **114**, which reduces the overall height most obviously. The first electronic element **124**, the second electronic element **126**, and the board-to-board connector **122** with smaller height is directly disposed on the surface **112** of the circuit board body **110**. Such a design avoids affecting the wiring disposition and the structural strength of the circuit board body **110** due to having too many grooves **114** on the circuit board body **110**.

(31) FIG. 4 is a schematic partial enlarged view of the circuit board body of FIG. 3. Referring to FIG. 4, the thickness T2 of the circuit board body **110** at each groove **114** must be at least half of the thickness T1 of the circuit board body **110** at a position other than the at least one groove **114**. The smaller the thickness T2 of the circuit board body **110** at each groove **114** is, the smaller the height of the camera element **120** protruding from the surface **112**.

(32) Specifically, the thickness T2 of the circuit board body **110** at each groove **114** is less than 0.2 mm, and the thickness T1 of the circuit board body **110** at positions other than the at least one groove **114** is less than 0.5 mm. For example, the thickness T2 of the circuit board body **110** at each groove **114** is 0.1 mm, and the thickness T1 of the circuit board body **110** at positions other than the at least one groove **114** is 0.35 mm. In an embodiment, for example, the circuit board body **110** is a six-layer board. Only one layer of board could be left at the groove **114**, and the thickness T2 at the groove **114** may also be 0.08 mm.

(33) In addition, the camera element **120** may also use a photosensitive element of a chip on board (COB) process with a lens with a small height, so that the height of the camera element **120** is small. The thickness T1 of the circuit board body **110** is relatively small, and the thickness T2 at the groove **114** is even smaller. Therefore, with the camera element **120** having a small height, the height of the circuit board module **100** is minimized.

(34) The circuit board module **100** of this embodiment is provided with a groove **114** on the circuit board body **110** to accommodate the camera element **120**, thereby reducing the overall height of the circuit board module **100**. By disposing part of the wiring on the external circuit board **130**, the width W of the circuit board body **110** is reduced, which is suitable to be applied to a device with a narrow frame. In addition, the circuit board module **100** of the embodiment shares part of the wiring through the external circuit board **130**. Thus, the camera element **120**, the first electronic element **124**, the second electronic element **126**, and the board-to-board connector **122** are able to be disposed on the relatively narrow circuit board body to provide multiple functions.

(35) In addition, in this embodiment, the portion of the circuit board body **110** other than the groove **114** may be a six-layer board. The inner layer of the circuit board body **110** may be selectively disposed of electrostatic protection elements (not shown), thereby improving the electromagnetic protection effect of the camera element **120**, the first electronic element **124**, the second electronic element **126**, and the board-to-board connector **122**.

(36) Furthermore, the wiring section **116** of the circuit board body **110** may be provided with optical alignment points or totems, such as copper dots (not shown), to facilitate the alignment of the camera element **120** during assembly. In addition, the thickness of the wiring section **116** of the circuit board body **110** is the same as the thickness of the circuit board body **110** at positions other than the groove **114** (both are thickness T1), which provides structural strength.

(37) FIG. 5 is a schematic partial enlarged side view of a circuit board body of a circuit board module of an embodiment according to the disclosure. Referring to FIG. 5, the main difference between the embodiment illustrated in FIG. 5 and the previous embodiments is that, in this embodiment, at least one groove **114a** is one groove **114a**. That is, the circuit board body **110a** has only a single groove **114a**, and the two camera elements **120** are disposed in the same groove **114a**.

Certainly, the relationship between the number of camera element **120** and the number of groove **114** and groove **114a** is not limited thereto.

(38) FIG. **6** is a schematic partial enlarged view of a circuit board module according to an embodiment of the disclosure. FIG. **7** is a schematic exploded view of FIG. **6**. Referring to FIG. **6** and FIG. **7**, the width **W** of the circuit board body **110** is greater than or equal to the width **W'** of the camera element **120a**. In this embodiment, the width **W** of the circuit board body **110** is the same as the width **W'** of the camera element **120**, so that the circuit board body **110** has a relatively narrow width **W**.

(39) In this embodiment, the camera element **120a** includes a photosensitive element **121** and a lens assembly **123**. Photosensitive element **121** is located in groove **114**. The lens assembly **123** is disposed on the photosensitive element **121**. A part of the lens assembly **123** is located in the groove **114**. Two sides of the lens assembly **123** are supported on the surface **112** of the circuit board body **110** beside the groove **114**. In this embodiment, the lens assembly **123** is a structure in which the lens **125** and the carrying base **127** are integrally formed, but the form of the lens assembly **123** is not limited thereto.

(40) The carrying base **127** includes a main section **128** and two extension sections **129**. The lens **125** is connected to the main section **128**, and the main section **128** is correspondingly disposed on the groove **114**. The two extension sections **129** are respectively located on two sides of the main section **128** and disposed on the surface **112** of the circuit board body **110** beside the groove **114**. As shown in FIG. **6**, in this embodiment, the thickness **T3** of the main section **128** plus the thickness **T2** of the circuit board body **110** at the groove **114** is substantially the same as the thickness **T4** of the extension section **129** plus the thickness **T1** of circuit board body **110** at positions other than the groove.

(41) The camera element **120a** is, for example, fixed to the groove **114** of the circuit board body **110** through the fixing member **140** and fixing member **142**. The fixing member **140** and fixing member **142** are, for example, glue, but the types of the fixing member **140** and fixing member **142** are not limited thereto.

(42) As shown in FIG. **7**, the contours of the two fixing members **140** correspond to the contours of the surface **112** and the groove **114** of the circuit board body **110** and are disposed between the lens assembly **123** and the surface **112** and the groove **114** of the circuit board body **110** along contours of the surface **112** and the groove **114** of the circuit board body **110**. In addition, two fixing members **142** are disposed on the surface **112** of the circuit board body **110** and contact two sides of the lens assembly **123** (i.e., the extension section **129**). Certainly, the positions of the fixing member **140** and the fixing member **142** are not limited thereto.

(43) To sum up, the circuit board body of the circuit board module of the disclosure includes a groove recessed in the surface. The camera element is disposed in the groove and electrically connected to the circuit board body to reduce the overall height of the circuit board module. In addition, because the circuit board body is provided with grooves, the space for disposing wiring on the circuit board body is relatively reduced. In order to obtain more wiring space, the connection port of the external circuit board is pluggably connected to the board-to-board of the circuit board body, so that the external circuit board is electrically connected to the circuit board body.

Therefore, the wiring originally to be disposed on the circuit board body is changed to the external circuit board. The external circuit board is used to make up for the space for disposing wiring on the circuit board body, thereby optimizing the wiring disposition.

(44) It will be apparent to those skilled in the art that various modifications and variations can be made to the disclosed embodiments without departing from the scope or spirit of the disclosure. In view of the foregoing, it is intended that the disclosure covers modifications and variations provided they fall within the scope of the following claims and their equivalents.

Claims

1. A circuit board module, comprising: a circuit board body comprising a surface and at least one groove recessed in the surface; two camera elements disposed in the at least one groove and electrically connected to the circuit board body; two board-to-board connectors disposed on the circuit board body; and an external circuit board comprising two connection ports, wherein the two connection ports are pluggably connected to the two board-to-board connectors, so that the external circuit board is electrically connected to the circuit board body.
2. The circuit board module according to claim 1, wherein the at least one groove comprises two grooves, and the two camera elements are respectively disposed in the two grooves.
3. The circuit board module according to claim 2, wherein the circuit board body comprises a wiring section between the two grooves, and the two camera elements are electrically connected to each other through the external circuit board, but not electrically connected to each other through the wiring section.
4. The circuit board module according to claim 1, wherein the external circuit board comprises a main section and two branches extending from the main section, and the two connection ports are respectively disposed on the two branches and pluggably connected to the two board-to-board connectors.
5. The circuit board module according to claim 1, further comprising: at least one first electronic element disposed on the surface and electrically connected to the circuit board body, wherein each of the board-to-board connectors is disposed on the surface, and a height of each of the board-to-board connectors and each of the at least one first electronic element is less than a height of each of the camera elements.
6. The circuit board module according to claim 5, further comprising: at least one second electronic element disposed on the surface and electrically connected to the circuit board body, wherein a height of each of the at least one second electronic element is less than the height of each of the camera elements.
7. The circuit board module according to claim 6, wherein each of the at least one first electronic element comprises a microphone, and each of the at least one second electronic element comprises a light source.
8. The circuit board module according to claim 6, wherein the at least one first electronic element comprises two first electronic elements, the at least one second electronic element comprises two second electronic elements, the two camera elements are adjacent to each other, the two first electronic elements are located on two sides of the two camera elements, the two second electronic elements are located on two sides of the two camera elements, and the two board-to-board connectors are located on two sides of the two camera elements.
9. The circuit board module according to claim 1, wherein the at least one groove is one groove, and the two camera elements are disposed in the groove.
10. The circuit board module according to claim 1, wherein the external circuit board is provided with wiring and no electronic part is disposed on the external circuit board.
11. The circuit board module according to claim 1, wherein a thickness of the circuit board body at each of the at least one groove is less than half of a thickness of the circuit board body at positions other than the at least one groove.
12. The circuit board module according to claim 1, wherein a thickness of the circuit board body at each of the at least one groove is less than 0.2 mm, and a thickness of the circuit board body at positions other than the at least one groove is less than 0.5 mm.
13. The circuit board module according to claim 1, wherein a width of the circuit board body is less than 3 mm.

14. The circuit board module according to claim 1, wherein a width of the circuit board body is the same as a width of each of the camera elements.
